Travel Logistics — Asper Business Case Competition 2027

Team: 1 professor + 4 students, travelling from Bielefeld, Germany **Event:** Asper Business Case Competition (ABCC), **February 18–22, 2027 Host:** Asper School of Business, University of Manitoba — Drake Centre, 181 Freedman Crescent, Winnipeg, MB R3T 5V4 **Team hotel:** Delta Hotels Winnipeg, 350 St. Mary Avenue (downtown) **Organizer contact:** aspercasecomps@umanitoba.ca

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1. Entry requirements: eTA for German citizens

German citizens are **visa-exempt** for Canada but need an **Electronic Travel Authorization (eTA)** to board a flight to Canada.

- **Apply only at the official site:** canada.ca/eta (IRCC). Third-party sites charge inflated fees for the same form.
- **Cost:** CAD 7 per person, paid online by credit/debit card.
- **What you need:** valid German passport, credit card, e-mail address; the form takes about 10 minutes and asks a few background questions.
- **Processing:** most applications are approved **within minutes** by e-mail, but some are flagged for document review and can take **several days** — apply as soon as passports are confirmed, not the week before departure.
- **Validity:** up to **5 years or until the passport expires**, whichever comes first. The eTA is **electronically linked to the passport number** used in the application — enter it carefully, and travel on exactly that passport. A new passport means a new eTA.
- **Passports:** must be valid for the intended stay; in practice aim for **6+ months validity beyond February 2027**. Have all five team members verify passports before booking flights (names on tickets must match passports exactly).
- An eTA does not guarantee entry; the border officer at first arrival in Canada makes the final decision. Carry the competition invitation letter and hotel confirmation in hand luggage.

Note on US transit: some cheap itineraries route via Minneapolis (MSP), Chicago (ORD) or Denver. Transiting the USA requires an **ESTA (currently USD 40)** and a full US immigration entry — avoidable hassle. **Route via Canada** and only an eTA is needed.

2. Flights: Germany → Winnipeg (YWG)

There are **no nonstop flights from Germany to Winnipeg**; plan one connection inside Canada.

Getting to the departure airport from Bielefeld: ICE from Bielefeld Hbf to **Frankfurt (FRA)** takes roughly 3–3.5 hours (Düsseldorf ~2 h is an alternative gateway). Lufthansa's **Rail&Fly** ticket protects the rail leg as part of the itinerary.

Typical routings (one stop):

Routing	Carriers	Approx. times
FRA → Toronto (YYZ) → YWG	Air Canada / Lufthansa + Air Canada, WestJet or Porter	FRA–YYZ ~8.5 h; YYZ–YWG ~2 h 50 min, many daily departures
FRA → Montreal (YUL) → YWG	Lufthansa / Air Canada	similar total, fewer onward frequencies
FRA or MUC → Calgary/Vancouver → YWG	Lufthansa + WestJet/Air Canada	backtracking eastward on the last leg
AMS → Calgary or Toronto → YWG	KLM + WestJet/connecting carrier	option if AMS fares are better; add rail to Amsterdam

The Toronto routing is the workhorse: door-to-door about **14–18 hours**. With the 7-hour time shift, a morning departure from Frankfurt lands you in Winnipeg by **evening the same day**.

Prices (economy return, February = low season): aggregator data shows Frankfurt–Winnipeg one-ways from roughly **US$370**; realistic return fares are about **€650–1,100 per person** including a checked bag, with Lufthansa/Air Canada often €900–1,200 if booked late. Budget ~**€1,000 per person** and book **3–6 months out** (i.e., by autumn 2026). Book all five travellers on the **same itinerary** and allow **minimum 2 hours** for the Toronto connection (you clear Canadian immigration and recheck bags at the first Canadian airport).

Recommended arrival: land **February 16 or 17** to absorb jet lag before the opening day on the 18th. Return flight on **February 22 or 23** (overnight eastbound, arriving Germany a day later).

3. Delta Hotels Winnipeg (team hotel)

The competition houses visiting teams at **Delta Hotels Winnipeg** (Marriott Bonvoy), **350 St. Mary Avenue, Winnipeg, MB R3C 3J2**, in the heart of downtown.

- **Skywalk connected:** direct indoor access to the city's skywalk system, the **RBC Convention Centre** and **Canada Life Centre** (Winnipeg Jets arena; older sources say "MTS Centre") — in February you can reach restaurants and shops without going outside.
- **Amenities:** indoor pool plus a heated **rooftop outdoor pool**, Odyssey Fitness Centre, **Blaze Restaurant & Lounge**, and the Urban Bean coffeehouse (serving Starbucks) for pre-round caffeine.
- **Booking:** the ABCC organizers typically arrange the room block — confirm with aspercasecomps@umanitoba.ca whether rooms are billed to teams and reserve early. Ask about a quiet room block; teams practice in rooms the night before rounds.
- ~10 km / 15 minutes by taxi from the airport.

4. Airport → downtown

Winnipeg's airport is **Winnipeg James Armstrong Richardson International (YWG)**, unusually close to the city (~10 km).

- **Taxi:** ~**CAD 20–30**, about **15 minutes** to the Delta. For 5 people plus luggage and a laptop bag each, take **two taxis** or request a van at the rank.
- **Ride-hailing:** Uber operates in Winnipeg at similar prices.
- **Public bus:** Winnipeg Transit routes serve the airport (adult cash fare ~**CAD 3.35–3.60**, ~40 min) — fine for a solo traveller, impractical for a team with suitcases at –20 °C.

On-the-ground contact card (print one per person; `07-logistics/competition_day_runbook.md` refers here)

Need	Contact
Emergency (police / fire / ambulance)	**911**
Organizers, all week	aspercasecomps@umanitoba.ca
On-site coordinator	Steven Harrison, **+1 204 396 9631** *(2025 cell — reconfirm in the 2027 guide)*
Taxi — Duffy's	**+1 204 925 0101**
Taxi — Unicity	**+1 204 925 3131**
Team hotel	Delta Hotels Winnipeg, 350 St. Mary Ave — *(copy the front-desk number off the booking confirmation)*
Venue	Drake Centre, 181 Freedman Crescent, Fort Garry campus
German consular assistance	Consulate General of Germany, Toronto (nearest full post) — verify the current number at germany.info before departure

Need	Contact
Insurance emergency line	*(fill in from your policy before flying)*

Ride-hailing (Uber) also operates city-wide; shuttles cover all official transfers, so treat taxis as the fallback when a shuttle is missed.

5. Campus, Drake Centre and daily transfers

The competition runs at the **Drake Centre** on the University of Manitoba's **Fort Garry campus**, about **11 km south of downtown** along the Red River — it is *not* walkable from the hotel. Options:

- **Organizer shuttles:** host schools usually shuttle teams between the Delta and campus — confirm the 2027 schedule with the coordinators and plan around it.
- **BLUE rapid transit line:** runs from downtown via the Southwest Transitway to the U of M campus in roughly **30 minutes**.
- **Uber/taxi:** ~20 minutes, roughly CAD 25–35 — the fallback for early boardroom-round call times.

The Drake Centre houses the Asper School of Business; competition rounds (prepared case, boardroom case, traditional case) run there, so treat it as your daytime base.

6. February weather and clothing — take this seriously

Winnipeg is one of the coldest major cities on Earth in winter. February averages: **high ≈ −9 °C, low ≈ −20 °C**, with cold snaps below **−30 °C** and wind chills that can feel like **−40**. Snow cover is constant but new snowfall is light (dry prairie cold); daylight is decent (~10 h, roughly 07:40–17:45).

Required kit per person:

- Insulated winter parka rated to −30 °C (hood essential)
- Warm hat covering the ears, scarf or neck gaiter, **insulated gloves or mittens**
- Thermal base layers (top and bottom) for any outdoor walking
- **Insulated, waterproof winter boots with grip** — pavements are icy; leather dress shoes outdoors are dangerous and will be ruined by road salt
- Wear boots in transit and **carry business shoes and suits in a garment bag**; everyone changes indoors. Lip balm and moisturizer help with the extremely dry air.

Downtown's skywalk network and the hotel's indoor links mean daily exposure can be minutes, not hours — but never underestimate the walk between a bus and a door.

7. Money, tipping, SIM

- **Currency:** Canadian dollar (CAD). Cards and contactless (Visa/Mastercard, Apple/Google Pay) work almost everywhere; carry only ~CAD 50–100 cash per person. Always choose to pay **in CAD**, never the terminal's euro conversion (DCC). Notify German banks of travel.
- **Taxes:** displayed prices exclude tax — Manitoba adds **5% GST + 7% PST (~12%)** at the till.
- **Tipping is expected: 15–20%** in restaurants (on the pre-tax amount), ~10–15% for taxis, CAD 1–2 per drink at bars/coffee counters, CAD 2–5 for hotel housekeeping.
- **Connectivity:** EU roaming rules do **not** apply in Canada and German-provider roaming is expensive. Best options: a **travel eSIM** (e.g., Airalo/Holafly-type, ~€15–30 for 10–20 GB Canada) bought before departure, or a Canadian prepaid SIM (Lucky Mobile, Chatr, Public Mobile, ~CAD 30–45/month). The University of Manitoba supports **eduroam** — university credentials should work on campus — and the hotel has Wi-Fi.

8. Travel insurance

- German statutory health insurance (**GKV**) provides **no coverage in Canada**, and Canadian care for visitors is expensive (an ER visit can exceed CAD 1,000; hospitalization far more). **Auslandsreisekrankenversicherung is mandatory for every team member** — annual policies (HanseMerkur, ADAC, TravelSecure, etc.) cost roughly €10–25 and must include **medical repatriation** ("medizinisch sinnvoller Rücktransport").
- Check whether the university's **Dienstreise/group travel policy** covers the professor and enrolled students — get written confirmation of who is covered for what.
- Given non-refundable fares booked months ahead, **trip cancellation insurance (Reiserücktritt)** for ~€3,500–5,000 total trip cost is sensible; baggage insurance is optional.

9. Jet lag strategy (7 hours)

Winnipeg is on **Central Standard Time (UTC−6)** in February; Germany is on CET (UTC+1) — Winnipeg is **7 hours behind Bielefeld**.

- **Before departure:** for 2–3 nights, go to bed and wake **1–2 hours later** than usual.
- **Flight day:** set watches to Winnipeg time at boarding; nap briefly (<1 h) early in the flight, then stay awake.
- **On arrival (evening local):** stay up until 21:30–22:00 local; avoid a long first-night lie-in.
- **First days:** seek **morning daylight**, keep caffeine before ~13:00 local, optional low-dose melatonin at local bedtime for the first 2–3 nights. Westbound adaptation is the easy direction — expect to be functional by day 2 and sharp by the first competition round if you arrive Feb 16/17. Morning presentations at 09:00 feel like 16:00 body time, which is favorable.
- **Return:** eastbound is harder — plan a light schedule for 3–4 days after arriving back and avoid teaching/exams the day after landing.

10. Booking countdown

When	Action
T−6 months (Aug 2026)	Confirm team registration with Asper; verify all 5 passports; **apply for eTAs (CAD 7 each)**; open flight-price alerts
T−5 to 4 months (Sep–Oct 2026)	**Book flights** (arrive Feb 16/17, depart Feb 22/23 — this envelope covers both possible 2027 weekday footprints, see note below); secure university funding approvals; confirm hotel block with organizers
T−3 months (Nov 2026)	Take out health + cancellation insurance; verify university Dienstreise coverage; students order/borrow −30 °C gear
T−2 months (Dec 2026)	Buy winter boots and gloves in end-of-year sales; order eSIMs; confirm shuttle arrangements with hosts
T−4 weeks (mid-Jan 2027)	Reconfirm eTA/passport match, seat assignments, garment bags; notify banks; print invitation letters and hotel confirmations; fill in and print the contact card in §4
T−1 week	Check Environment Canada forecast for Winnipeg; begin sleep-shifting; pack (boots on feet, suits in carry-on); online check-in 24 h out

Booking note — the 2027 weekday question. *The competition is published as February 18–22, 2027, which falls **Thursday–Monday**, but every ABCC-format edition has started on a **Wednesday** (2024: Feb 21; 2025: Feb 19; 2026: Feb 18). If the Wednesday pattern holds, the real week is Wed Feb 17 – Sun Feb 21. **Arriving Feb 16/17 and returning Feb 22/23 covers both readings** — so book that envelope, keep tickets changeable if the fare difference is small, and do not commit hotel nights to a specific round order until the 2027 agenda is out. Details: `01-competition/facts_and_rules.md`, "The 2027 weekday question".*

Sources

- Asper Business Case Competition — University of Manitoba (dates, rounds, Drake Centre, Delta hotel)
- Government of Canada — eTA facts and eTA: how to apply
- Skyscanner — Frankfurt to Winnipeg fares
- FlightConnections — Toronto (YYZ) to Winnipeg (YWG)
- InnVest Hotels — Delta Winnipeg property details
- Tourism Winnipeg — Delta rooftop pool
- Welcome Pickups — Winnipeg airport to downtown
- Wanderlog — Winnipeg weather in February and Climate-Data.org — Winnipeg February
- Winnipeg Transit — fares and Transit App — BLUE rapid transit line

Prices, fares and schedules researched July 2026 — reverify key figures (flights, transit fares, eTA fee) when booking.